

science & technology, government of Karnataka, under the guidance of Vision Group on Nanotechnology.

As fossil fuels will exhaust by 2050, the world needs to look at alternative energy sources and nanotechnology can increase the efficiencies of several stages of value chains in the production of energy from wind, gases, solar cells, etc. We have 60,000 MW of wind power potential in India, but don't use even 12,000 MW because of several issues from production to storing.

Chairing the session, Puneet Mehrotra, director, Nano Science & Technology Consortium, said, "Many application areas of nanotechnology can benefit the energy sector, whether it is nano-optimised fuel cells or efficient solar cells. In energy storage, reducing transmission losses and reducing consumption, nanotechnology can play a vital role. Cost reduction in the production of renewable energies is another thrust area for nanotechnology."

DRDO to set up a nano foundry

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) plans to set up a nano foundry by investing Rs 5-6 billion. This project will be a cluster with the partnering of IITs and other academic institutions of India. The R&D facilities for nanotechnology can be used by the industry and academic institutions for research purpose. Moreover, DRDO will also fund nano research at the academic institutions.

Dr W. Selvamurthy, chief controller, R&D, DRDO, said, "Nanotechnology has several applications from agriculture to defence. So far, academic institutions are working as islands of excellence and they need to work like a continent of excellence. A research in one specialisation need not be limited to applications in that specialisation. That can contribute a lot in totally different sectors."

Moser Baer sets up solar farm in Tamil Nadu

Moser Baer Clean Energy Limited has commissioned India's largest and the

Amara Raja Power Systems wins ISQA 2010 Award

Amara Raja Power Systems Ltd (ARPSL), a company in manufacture, design and installation of power delivery systems, has won the IEEMA SME Quality Award for the year 2010.

Receiving the award, Ramachandra N. Galla, chairman, Amara Raja Group, said, "This is the third year in succession that Amara Raja Power Systems has won the IEEMA recognition. The progress over the years has been from the third-level recognition to top level this year, indicating a continuous improvement in our quality journey."

first 5MW solar farm at Sivaganga in Tamil Nadu. The technical expertise for commissioning was provided by the Engineering Procurement Commissioning arm of Moser Baer Solar. The solar farm has been commissioned using amorphous-silicon thin-film technology (best suited for the Indian climatic conditions) and is connected to the 110kVA local grid.

Moser Baer India has successfully installed 100MW solar capacity globally. The company commissioned the first-of-its-kind 1MW thin-film solar farm in Maharashtra and one of the largest residential roof-top solar PV installations in Surat.

Huawei to invest above \$2 billion

Chinese telecom gear maker Huawei plans to invest more than \$2 billion in India in research and manufacturing. The money will be used over the next five years to set up a new R&D campus in Bengaluru and an equipment manufacturing facility at Sriperumbudur near Chennai, and also for a number of business partnerships in the country. Huawei also plans to ramp up its R&D employee strength from the current 2000 to 3000.

"The comprehensive five-year plan will focus on the development, augmentation and cooperation in the areas of local R&D, local manufacturing, technology cooperation with Indian IT service companies, local sourcing, local employment, talent development, and supporting rural education and IT literacy in India," said a company statement.

Meanwhile, Huawei has started

its first-phase local manufacturing in Chennai and is further exploring other forms of cooperation in local manufacturing.

Nikon starts collection centres

In order to cater to the wider base of Nikon customers, Nikon India has floated collection points across India, especially non-metro areas.

Hiroshi Takashina, managing director, Nikon India, said, "We wanted to negate the problems that Nikon customers in such non-metro areas are currently facing with regards to repair of their products. The new collection centres will provide users with a service or facility through which they can get their products repaired without facing any problem. This is a step towards bringing our customers closer to the brand Nikon."

The Nikon collection centres would act as the main contact point for collection of any Nikon imaging product (D-SLRs, COOLPIX compact cameras, NIKKOR lenses and accessories) and send it for repair to the nearest service facility centre for necessary correction. Once repaired, the product will be sent back to the collection centre from where the customer can collect his product.

DoCoMo plans mobile TV service for India

Japanese cellphone carrier DoCoMo plans to bring its mobile phone TV service to the Indian market. The company is mulling transfer of its television broadcast technology for cellphones to its partner Tata Teleservices. The new